

15-BALL ROTATION

15-Ball Rotation — Standard Rules

House rules for Columbia Cue Club, structured in the style of the WPA Rules of Play.

ABOUT 15-BALL ROTATION

15-Ball Rotation is 15-ball rotation played to a target score. Fifteen numbered balls are racked and played in ascending numerical order. Every ball legally pocketed scores one point. Pocketing the 15 does not end the rack — play continues until every ball is off the table, so a completed rack always totals exactly 15 points between the two players; only a player reaching the target score ends a rack early, with balls still on the table. The first player to reach the agreed target — traditionally a multiple of 25 (25, 50, 100, or 150), as in Straight Pool — wins the Match.

HOW 15-BALL ROTATION COMBINES 10-BALL AND 14.1

15-Ball Rotation borrows rotation order and called shots from WPA 10-Ball, and 1-point-per-ball, race-to-N scoring from WPA 14.1 Continuous Pool. Like 10-Ball, shots must be called (ball + pocket) with two exceptions: the break shot (slop counts) and any ball that falls on the same shot as a legally-called-and-made ball. Unlike 14.1, balls must be contacted in numerical order. All other WPA general rules apply unchanged.

HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Every rule heading carries a source chip. Look for these:

[15-Ball] New 15-Ball Rotation rule — bold italic heading. The reader's key differences.

[15-Ball · 10-Ball] Adapted from WPA 10-Ball with a 15-Ball Rotation change — bold heading.

[15-Ball · 14.1] Adapted from WPA 14.1 Continuous with a 15-Ball Rotation change — bold heading.

[10-Ball] Unchanged from WPA 10-Ball (cross-referenced, not reproduced).

[14.1] Unchanged from WPA 14.1 Continuous (cross-referenced, not reproduced).

[WPA General] Unchanged from WPA general rules or fouls (cross-referenced).

VERSION

15-Ball Rotation Rules v1.0

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QR

Scan: WPA Rules of Play (10-Ball, p. 24)

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1. GENERAL

1.1 APPLICABILITY OF THE WPA GENERAL RULES

All rules in WPA Section 1 (General Rules) apply to 15-Ball Rotation unchanged. This includes WPA 1.1 Player's Responsibility, 1.2 Lagging to Determine First Break, 1.3 Subsequent Breaks, 1.4 Player's Use of Equipment, 1.5 Spotting Balls, 1.6 Cue-Ball in Hand, 1.8 Balls Settling, 1.9 Restoring a Position, 1.10 Outside Interference, 1.11 Prompting Calls and Protesting Rulings, 1.12 Concession, and 1.13 Stalemate. WPA 1.7 Standard Call Shot applies to 15-Ball Rotation with two named exceptions defined in K.5: the break shot and any extra ball pocketed on the same shot as a legally-called-and-made ball.

1.2 APPLICABILITY OF THE WPA FOULS

All fouls defined in WPA Section 3 (Fouls) apply to 15-Ball Rotation as listed under K.9 (Standard Fouls) and K.10 (Serious Fouls). Any WPA foul not explicitly listed nevertheless remains in force where relevant to normal play.

1.3 GAME OVERVIEW

15-Ball Rotation is a rotation Discipline played with fifteen object-balls numbered 1 through 15 and the cue-ball. The object-balls are played in ascending numerical order. Each legally pocketed ball counts one point. The first player to reach the target score wins the Match. The standard targets are 25 points (recreational) and 50 points (competitive). Any other target may be agreed to before the Match and, when different from 25 or 50, must be noted on the score sheet.

WHAT'S NEW IN 15-BALL ROTATION

If you already know 10-Ball or 14.1, these are the 15-Ball-Rotation-specific rules to learn. Each one is marked [15-Ball] in the body of this document. All other rules are pointers into the current WPA Rules of Play.

K.0 Ball in Hand Every Inning — No Safeties [15-Ball]

The most distinctive rule of 15-Ball Rotation: every incoming player begins their inning with the cue-ball in hand anywhere on the playing surface. This applies after ANY inning change — after a missed shot, after a foul, after a made ball where the shooter chose to end their inning, and after the break. Because BIH is guaranteed every inning, safety play is meaningless and NOT permitted: you cannot 'leave your opponent bad.' Fouls are instead deterred by the –1-point penalty in K.9.

K.2 The Rack [15-Ball]

The 1-ball on the Foot Spot at the apex, the 8-ball in the center of the triangle, the 15-ball and remaining balls placed randomly.

K.5 Called Shots (with Two Slop Exceptions) [15-Ball]

Every shot except the break must be called: name the object-ball and the pocket. Only the called ball into the called pocket scores. Slop counts in exactly two situations: (1) on a legal break — any ball pocketed stays down and scores for the breaker; and (2) when your called ball drops into the called pocket AND another ball also falls on the same shot — the extra ball scores as a bonus. In every other case an uncalled make is spotted, no score, and the turn ends (incoming player takes BIH).

K.8 Scoring — 1 Point per Ball, Race to Target [15-Ball]

Each ball legally pocketed = 1 point. Each foul = –1 point. The Match ends the moment a player's SUBTOTAL reaches the target (25 or 50) on a legal shot; no single ball is the winning ball. Any additional balls pocketed in that winning rack may be recorded to a higher FINAL total for personal-best or high-score purposes, but do not affect who won or when.

K.6 No Special Spotting [15-Ball]

Unlike WPA 10-Ball, there is no rule that spots the highest ball when pocketed on a foul. Any ball pocketed on a foul or safety is spotted per WPA 1.5 like any other ball.

K.7 Continuing Play Across Racks [15-Ball]

When the 15-ball is legally pocketed, the balls are re-racked and the shooter continues with a new break under K.3. The Match does not end at rack boundaries — only when the target score is reached.

K. 15-BALL ROTATION

15-Ball Rotation is a rotation Discipline played with fifteen object-balls numbered 1 through 15 and the cue-ball. The object-balls must be contacted in ascending numerical order (rotation). Each ball legally pocketed counts one point, and the first player to reach the target score wins the Match. Shots must be called (ball + pocket), with two named exceptions detailed in K.5.

K.2 THE RACK [15-Ball]

The fifteen object-balls are racked as tightly as possible in a triangular shape:

- (a) The 1-ball is at the apex of the triangle, on the Foot Spot.
- (b) The 8-ball is placed in the center of the triangle.
- (c) The 15-ball and the remaining object-balls are placed without purposeful or intentional pattern.

K.0 BALL IN HAND EVERY INNING — NO SAFETIES [15-Ball]

This is the signature rule of 15-Ball Rotation. Every incoming player begins their inning with the cue-ball in hand anywhere on the playing surface. This applies:

- (a) After the opponent misses or ends their inning without pocketing.
- (b) After any foul by the opponent (in addition to the –1-point penalty in K.9).
- (c) After the break — see K.3 for the special break case.
- (d) After the opponent legally pockets a ball but chooses to end their inning (rare, but permitted).

Because ball-in-hand is guaranteed every inning, safety play is meaningless and NOT permitted as a strategic choice in 15-Ball Rotation. There is no “declared safety.” You cannot leave your opponent bad, because your opponent picks up the cue-ball and places it wherever they choose. The –1-point foul penalty in K.9 replaces ball-in-hand as the deterrent for illegal shots.

K.5 CALLED SHOTS (WITH TWO SLOP EXCEPTIONS) [15-Ball]

15-Ball Rotation is a call-shot Discipline. On every shot except the break, the shooter must call the object-ball and the pocket. Obvious balls (a straight-in shot into the nearest pocket) need not be verbally called per WPA 1.7. Only the called ball into the called pocket scores.

The called ball need not be the lowest-numbered ball. The rotation requirement is on the FIRST CONTACT: the cue-ball must first contact the lowest-numbered ball on the table. The shooter may then call any ball into any pocket — for example, hitting the 2-ball first and driving the 7 into the corner (called: 7 in that corner). Failing to contact the lowest ball first is a foul under K.9 regardless of what falls.

Slop counts in exactly two situations, and nowhere else:

- (a) THE BREAK. On a legal break shot, any ball pocketed stays down and scores for the breaker (see K.3). No call is required on the break.
- (b) BONUS EXTRA BALL. When the shooter legally pockets the called ball into the called pocket AND another object-ball also falls on the same shot, that extra ball scores as a bonus. The shooter continues at the table.

In every other case, a pocketed uncalled ball is SPOTTED, no points are awarded for that ball, and the shooter's inning ends. The incoming player takes ball-in-hand per K.0 (no foul penalty; an uncalled make is a missed shot, not a foul, unless a WPA Section 3 foul also occurred). If a shot is played without calling and multiple balls fall, none of them count and all are spotted. Declared safeties are still NOT permitted (K.0).

K.6 SPOTTING BALLS [15-Ball]

Balls are spotted per WPA 1.5. 15-Ball Rotation has no special provision for the highest-numbered ball; the 15-ball is treated like any other object-ball. If it is pocketed on a foul or on a declared safety, it is spotted per WPA 1.5.

K.7 CONTINUING PLAY [15-Ball]

If the shooter legally pockets at least one object-ball on a shot and does not foul, the shooter continues at the table. If the shooter misses, plays a safety, or fouls, play passes to the opponent. When the 15-ball is legally pocketed, all fifteen balls are re-racked (see K.2) and the player whose turn it is continues shooting, breaking the new rack under the requirements of K.3. The Match does not end at rack boundaries; it ends only when a player reaches the target score.

K.8 SCORING [15-Ball]

- (a) Each object-ball legally pocketed scores one point for the shooter.
- (b) Each foul subtracts one point from the offending player's score. Only one foul penalty is assessed per shot, even when multiple infractions occur (per WPA 3).
- (c) The Match ends the moment a player's SUBTOTAL first reaches the agreed target score on a legal shot. Any legal ball may be the winning ball; there is no dedicated "money ball" (contrast WPA 10-Ball, where only the 10-ball wins).
- (d) Once a player has reached the target, any additional balls pocketed in that same winning rack may be recorded to a higher FINAL total for personal-best or house high-score purposes. This does not change who won, nor when the Match ended; the record is simply a courtesy for the winning player. Recording extra balls is optional; if either player prefers, play stops at the target.
- (e) The standard targets are 25 points (recreational) and 50 points (competitive). Any other target may be agreed to before the Match starts and must be noted on the score sheet.

K.3 LEGAL BREAK SHOT [15-Ball]

- (a) The cue-ball begins in hand above the Head String (see WPA 1.6 Cue-Ball in Hand and WPA 3.10 Bad Cue-Ball Placement).
- (b) The first object-ball contacted by the cue-ball must be the 1-ball.
- (c) If no object-ball is pocketed, at least four object-balls must be driven to one or more rails, or the shot is a break foul (see (d)).
- (d) Break scoring: on a LEGAL break, every ball pocketed scores 1 point for the breaker and remains pocketed. On a BREAK FOUL (illegal break, scratch on the break, or cue-ball off the table), all object-balls pocketed on the break are SPOTTED per WPA 1.5, and the breaker receives the standard -1-point penalty from K.9.
- (e) After the break — pocket or no pocket, legal break or break foul — the incoming player takes ball in hand anywhere on the table under K.0. The breaker never continues their inning after the break shot; play always passes to the opponent.

K.1 DETERMINING THE BREAK [15-Ball · 10-Ball]

Players lag as described in WPA 1.2 (Lagging to Determine First Break). The player who wins the lag chooses who will break the first Rack. Subsequent breaks alternate between players (WPA 1.3).

K.9 STANDARD FOULS [15-Ball]

If the shooter commits a standard foul, one point is subtracted from his score, and play passes to the opponent. Note that BIH already applies at the start of every inning under K.0; the foul penalty is the -1-point score adjustment, NOT ball-in-hand. A player's score may go below zero; there is no floor. The following standard fouls apply at 15-Ball Rotation; refer to the WPA Rules of Play for the definitive text:

- WPA 3.1 Cue-Ball Scratch or Off the Table.
- WPA 3.2 Wrong Ball First — the first object-ball contacted by the cue-ball on each shot must be the lowest-numbered ball remaining on the table.
- WPA 3.3 No Rail after Contact.
- WPA 3.4 No Foot on Floor.
- WPA 3.5 Ball Driven Off the Table — all such balls are spotted.
- WPA 3.6 Touched Ball.
- WPA 3.7 Double Hit / Frozen Balls.
- WPA 3.8 Push Shot.
- WPA 3.9 Balls Still Moving.
- WPA 3.10 Bad Cue-Ball Placement.
- WPA 3.12 Playing Out of Turn.
- WPA 3.14 Slow Play.
- WPA 3.15 Ball Rack Template Foul.

K.10 SERIOUS FOULS [WPA General]

For WPA 3.13 (Three Consecutive Fouls), the penalty is loss of the current Rack: all balls in the current rack are re-racked, the offending player's consecutive-foul count is reset, and the offending player must break under K.3. For WPA 3.16 (Unsportsmanlike Conduct), the referee — or, in unofficiated play, mutual agreement of the players — will choose a penalty appropriate to the offense, up to and including forfeiture of the Match.

K.11 STALEMATE [WPA General]

If a stalemate occurs as described in WPA 1.13, the original breaker of the current Rack breaks again under K.3. Points scored prior to the stalemate remain in effect.

APPENDIX A — COMPARISON WITH 10-BALL AND 14.1

The table below summarises how 15-Ball Rotation relates to the two WPA disciplines it borrows from. 15-Ball Rotation adopts rotation, called shots, and standard fouls from 10-Ball, and 1-point-per-ball / race-to-target scoring from 14.1. Its distinguishing rules are ball-in-hand every inning with no safeties (K.0), the two-slop-exception model for calls (K.5 — slop counts on the break and for a bonus extra ball only), and race-to-target with no single winning ball (K.8).

	15-Ball Rotation	10-Ball (WPA 6)	14.1 (WPA 7)
Object-balls	1 through 15	1 through 10	1 through 15
Play order	Rotation (lowest)	Rotation (lowest)	Any legal ball
Call shots?	Yes (slop on break + bonus)	Yes	Yes
Scoring	1 pt per ball	Winning-ball only	1 pt per ball
Win condition	First to reach target	Legally pocket 10	First to reach target
Foul penalty	–1 point, BIH	BIH (rack-based)	–1 point, BIH-above
Race target	25 or 50	N/A (rack-based)	Match-dependent
Re-rack when	15 pocketed	After each rack	14 pocketed (keep 15th)
Rack apex	1-ball, 8 in center	1-ball, 10 in center	Apex ball (varies)

APPENDIX B — WORKED SCORING EXAMPLES

The examples below illustrate how points and fouls combine over a series of racks. Each example assumes a race to 25.

B.1 Simple run of three racks [15-Ball]

- Rack 1: Player A legally pockets 8 balls, then misses. RACK TOTAL = 8. Player B pockets the remaining 7. Rack 1 GAME SUBTOTAL: A = 8, B = 7.
- Rack 2: A pockets 10 balls (including one bank that was called and made), then commits a scratch foul on the 12-ball. RACK TOTAL = 10 – 1 = 9. B pockets the remaining 5. Rack 2 SUBTOTAL: A = 8 + 9 = 17, B = 7 + 5 = 12.
- Rack 3: B breaks and pockets 13 balls in a row. B's SUBTOTAL hits 25 on the ball that took B from 24 to 25 — B wins the Match at that instant. B chooses to continue and pocket the last 2 balls of the rack for a FINAL total of 27, recorded as high score. A's FINAL = 17.

B.2 Foul penalty near a low score [15-Ball]

A score may go negative from foul penalties (per WPA 14.1 tradition). If a player is at 0 and commits a foul, that player's SUBTOTAL becomes –1. Recording is straightforward on the score sheet: enter the negative RACK TOTAL and carry it forward to the next SUBTOTAL cell.

APPENDIX C — WPA CROSS-REFERENCE INDEX

Every WPA rule cited in this document is listed below with its WPA section number. Scan the QR on the cover (or visit wpapool.com/rules/) to open the current WPA Rules of Play PDF, where these sections appear verbatim.

WPA §	Rule	Used in 15-Ball Rotation as
WPA 1.2	Lagging to Determine First Break	cited in K.1
WPA 1.3	Subsequent Breaks	cited in K.1
WPA 1.5	Spotting Balls	cited in K.4, K.6
WPA 1.6	Cue-Ball in Hand	cited in K.3, K.9
WPA 1.7	Standard Call Shot	applied with K.5 exceptions
WPA 1.13	Stalemate	cited in K.11
WPA 3.1	Cue-Ball Scratch or Off the Table	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.2	Wrong Ball First	standard foul (lowest ball first)
WPA 3.3	No Rail after Contact	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.4	No Foot on Floor	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.5	Ball Driven Off the Table	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.6	Touched Ball	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.7	Double Hit / Frozen Balls	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.8	Push Shot	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.9	Balls Still Moving	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.10	Bad Cue-Ball Placement	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.12	Playing Out of Turn	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.13	Three Consecutive Fouls	serious foul at 15-Ball Rotation (K.10)
WPA 3.14	Slow Play	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.15	Ball Rack Template Foul	standard foul at 15-Ball Rotation
WPA 3.16	Unsportsmanlike Conduct	serious foul at 15-Ball Rotation (K.10)